TOPIC REPORTS: ENERGY

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News, Sep – Oct 2026

CONNECTIVITY · DATA STORAGE · ENERGY · TECHNICAL CAPACITY · CYBERSECURITY

Botswana · Congo · DR Congo · Ethiopia · Kenya · Libya · Sierra Leone · South Africa · South Sudan

Botswana

ELECTRICITY TARIFF APPLICATION 2026-27

- **BPC 2026-27 Electricity Tariff Application — Consultation Paper** — Botswana Energy Regulatory Authority (BERA), 15 December 2025

  Botswana Power Corporation's tariff application for 2026/27, put to consultation by the regulator BERA, seeks a 46% increase from 1 April 2026. BPC puts its revenue requirement at P9.585bn against current revenue of P6.108bn excluding subsidy, a gap of P3.477bn.

Congo

ENERGY COST AND RELIABILITY FOR DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Congo/Télécommunications : L'Arpce présente la 2e édition du Livre blanc et le projet d'adressage postal numérique** — Agence Congolaise d'Information, 17 October 2026

  Congo's communications regulator Arpce presented the second edition of its white paper and a digital postal addressing project on 15 October 2026, the state news agency reported. Figures cited include internet penetration of 57%, mobile money use of 55.8% and 22 internet service providers.

DR Congo

EMERGENT GRID COMPUTE-ANCHORED MINI-GRID DEMONSTRATION

- **The Rockefeller Foundation and Mission 300 Accelerator Launch Demonstration to Test Whether AI Demand Can Help Finance Energy Access in Africa** — The Rockefeller Foundation, 24 September 2026

  KENYA · SIERRA LEONE · AFRICA

  The Rockefeller Foundation's Mission 300 Accelerator announced the Emergent Grid Project on 24 September 2026, testing whether AI computing placed at African mini-grids can act as an anchor customer and improve their finances. The first sites are five in Kenya, a solar plant in DR Congo and three in Sierra Leone, serving about 85,000 people, with local electricity demand given priority over computing. No amount is stated.

Ethiopia

BITDEER OROMIA BITCOIN-MINING SITE

- **Ethiopia Sacrifices Lucrative Bitcoin Mining Revenue as Hydropower Crisis Deepens** — Norvanreports, 15 September 2026

The state power utility cut supply to bitcoin mining and data-mining operations as a hydropower shortfall deepened, giving up the revenue that load was earning.

Kenya

EMERGENT GRID COMPUTE-ANCHORED MINI-GRID DEMONSTRATION

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Libya

OFF-GRID SOLAR ELECTRIFICATION OF REMOTE AREAS

- **مشروع كهربة المناطق النائية باستخدام منظومات الخلايا الشمسية** — جهاز الطاقات المتجددة (Renewable Energy Authority of Libya, REAOL), 3 September 2026

  Libya's renewable energy authority sets out its off-grid programme: 400 solar systems at 310 kW peak, serving remote population clusters and border posts. It is the largest counted state provision outside the cities the repository holds for the country.

Sierra Leone

EMERGENT GRID COMPUTING PILOT AT RURAL MINI-GRIDS

- **The Rockefeller Foundation and Mission 300 Accelerator Launch Demonstration to Test Whether AI Demand Can Help Finance Energy Access in Africa** — The Rockefeller Foundation, 24 September 2026 KENYA DRC AFRICA

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South Africa

STRATEGIC FRAMEWORK FOR OFFSHORE WIND DEVELOPMENT

- **A Strategic Framework for Offshore Wind Development in South Africa** — World Bank / ESMAP, 10 September 2026

  The World Bank published a strategic framework for offshore wind in South Africa, prepared by the Carbon Trust with the Department of Electricity and Energy and funded by ESMAP, posted on 10 September 2026. It estimates about 95 GW of technical potential along the 2,800 km coastline and notes that rules on site exclusivity and seabed leasing have not been enacted.

- **South Africa sees offshore wind powering AI data centres** — TechCentral, 17 September 2026

> South Africa's electricity and energy department published a strategic framework for offshore wind, identifying about 95GW of technical potential along the coastline and naming energy-hungry coastal users, data centres among them, as the customers who could justify building it. The laws and regulations the build would need do not yet exist and the costs are large.

South Sudan

> CREI SOLAR-HYBRID TELECOM ENERGY PROGRAMME
>
> - **MTN South Sudan Expands Network Coverage to 85% Through Infrastructure Modernisation** — Tech Africa News, 14 September 2026
>
> MTN South Sudan says population broadband coverage rose from 76.6% to 85% and network availability to 99% over two years, after more than 500 sites were modernised with CREI's solar-hybrid power. Diesel use at supported sites fell by more than half; no investment figure is given.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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